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Measures of volume in the Old Testament

11.3.1 Measures of volume in the Old Testament

Schneider has suggested substituting the names of known containers that contain approximately the volume or capacity indicated by the biblical name. Thus, for example, some cultures will have a special name for a basket or sack that holds about 25 liters (50 pounds) of grain, which is approximately equal to the *'eyfah*. It is recommended that translators investigate this possibility in their own setting. A word of caution, however, is in order. One should avoid words that are clearly anachronistic, words which indicate containers made of plastic or tin alloy. Thus, for example, in LEV 14:10 the *'eyfah* of fine flour is to be mixed with a *log* (about half a liter) of oil. It would be inappropriate to say "mixed with one can of oil," although it would be possible to say "mixed with two cups of oil."

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